



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

Attendance and Punctuality Policy Civilian Staff

Title: JCF Attendance and Punctuality Policy Civilian Staff		Identification Code: JCF/HRD/PL/SFs/0002/2021	
Effective Date: 2024-Nov-27		Pages: 12	
Review Date: 2024-Nov-22		Distribution: Limited	
Revision version # 1		Process Owners: Deputy Commissioner of Police Administration & Support Services Portfolio	
Rescinds: 2021-Nov-12			
Authors: ACP Administration Branch		Owner: JCF	
Publication: 2021-Nov-12		Review: Triennially	



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE
POLICE DEPARTMENT
HUMAN RESOURCE
DIVISION

ATTENDANCE AND PUNCTUALITY
POLICY
CIVILIAN STAFF



**JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE
POLICE DEPARTMENT**

HUMAN RESOURCE DIVISION

ATTENDANCE AND PUNCTUALITY POLICY

CIVILIAN STAFF

Objective

The purpose of this policy is to propound the Jamaica Constabulary Force's policy and procedure for managing employee absences and tardiness to encourage minimal unscheduled absences and efficient operations across all divisions.

Policy Statement

Prompt and regular attendance is an essential responsibility of all members of staff at the Jamaica Constabulary Force. It is an expectation of all members of staff to report to work at the scheduled time and be prepared to work for the duration of such time. To ensure adequate staffing, positive employee morale, and to meet expected productivity standards throughout the organization, employees will be held accountable for adhering to their work schedule.

Timely and regular attendance is an expectation of performance for all employees.

ATTENDANCE

1. Attendance Register

- 1.1 Employees should personally record their **arrival and departure time** in the attendance register daily.
- 1.2 Absent employee's name should be written in red ink indicating the reason for absence (e.g. sick/casual/vacation leave/day release etc.) In the remarks column.
- 1.3 Employees who are travelling should inform their Supervisor or Assigned Officer so that it can be recorded in the attendance book. In cases where officers are travelling, on site visit etc. Their names should be written in the attendance register and the appropriate comment made in the remarks column.

2. Submission of Time and Attendance Report

- 2.1 Each unit is **required** to submit a monthly time and attendance report (see attendance sheet(s) attached).
- 2.2 Employees who are able to telecommute and are granted permission to work from home (during the pandemic) are expected to submit a work schedule of what will be produced weekly. Supervisors are **required** to select an officer to submit the listing of staff granted permission to work from home for the records.

PUNCTUALITY

3. Punctuality

- 3.1 The official work hours are 8:30 a.m. to 5:00 p.m., Mondays to Thursdays and 8:30 a.m. to 4:00 p.m. on Fridays.
- 3.2 The official work hours for ancillary employees' are 7:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. or 8:00 a.m. to 4:00 p.m.
- 3.3 Employees are given a grace period of 15 mins. If employees arrive after that allotted time it is considered late. That means, once the officer arrives within the period, he/she is considered to be 'on time'.
- 3.4 In calculating time loss, a grace period of fifteen (15) minutes from 8:30 a.m. will be allowed. However, if an employee arrives later than 8:45 a.m., the time lost be calculated from 8:30 a.m. For example, if an employee arrives at 8:50 a.m., the time lost will be recorded as twenty (20) minutes.
- 3.5 The official work hours for part time employees are four (4) hours per day. (These employees are exempt from nos. 3.4 and 3.5). If these persons are absent then no. 3.6 should apply.
- 3.6 Officers, who sign in after 8:45 a. m. because of an official pre-arranged appointment or meeting off-site, should so indicate in the comments column of the Register. In this circumstance, the officer would be regarded as being "on time". Note however, that where time-off was sought for personal matters and the officer realizes that he/she will arrive at 11:00 a.m. or later, then the officer should apply for leave to cover the day.
- 3.7 In keeping with the generally accepted custom and practice, whenever employees work schedules are in keeping with the hours stated earlier, but because of extraneous circumstances are given permission to arrive at work late, the cut off time of arrival is 11:00 a.m. Absence beyond 11:00 a.m. is to be charged as a day's leave.
- 3.8 For services which operate on time schedules which are different from the times set out the deadline for permitted late arrival is two and a half (2 ½) hours after the official starting time. Absence beyond two and a half (2 ½) hours of official starting time is to be charged as leave.
- 3.9 Officers requiring to be absent during the work day for personal reasons, should seek the permission of the supervisors to be absent from their Division/Unit at any time of the day outside of their agreed lunch hour.
- 3.10 Officers who are granted permission by HRM&D Unit to leave work for study purposes before 5:00 p.m. Mondays-Thursdays and 4:00 p. m. Fridays are expected to reduce the time lost by arriving at work earlier and /or shortening the one (1) hour lunch break allowed.

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- 3.11 All Officers are required to apply in advance and receive approval for Departmental leave from the Head of Division/Unit. Where this is impossible, communication to the Head of Division/Unit should be done on the first day of absence.
- 3.12 Officers who are ill and are unable to come to work, are expected to communicate this information to the Head of Division/Unit on the first day of absence. A Medical Certificate must be submitted in support of absences in excess of three (3) consecutive days (that is, four (4) or more consecutive days).
- 3.13 If an Officer has exceeded his/her allocation of sick and departmental leave within the specified one (1) year period, the leave will be charged as vacation leave and if this leave is exhausted then the period will be treated as no-pay leave.
- 3.14 Each Division/Area is required to submit to the Human Resource Management and Development Division, a Time & Attendance Report on a monthly basis. Late time should be calculated from 8:30 a. m. the report for each month must be submitted on or before the 10th of the succeeding month. Each Head of Unit/Area is therefore expected to select an officer to manage this function and liaise with the HRMD.

4. Supervisor's Responsibility

- 4.1 Supervisors are expected to meet regularly with the general staff, and individually where required, to discuss habitual late coming and/or requests for frequent time-off during the work day, with a view to encouraging officers to make every effort to remedy the situation so as to avert the necessity for disciplinary action.
- 4.2 Supervisors should monitor their employees' attendance on a regular basis and address unsatisfactory attendance in a timely and consistent manner. If supervisors notice a pattern of lateness and regular absence from work, they should discuss concerns with the employee.
- 4.3 Supervisors are **required** select an officer to submit the listing of staff granted permission to work from home (during the pandemic) for the records.
- 4.4 Timely and regular attendance is a performance expectation of all employees. Consequently, those employees who have exhibited unsatisfactory attendance will

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result in disciplinary action. Supervisors are expected to reaffirm the
aforementioned to staff.

5. Human Resource Management and Development Division's Responsibility

Once all options have been exhausted by the Head of Divisions, the Human Resource Management and Development Division will proceed with the following infractions and sanction below:

5.1 Being late for work for more than five (5) times **or** having a total loss of more than one hundred and twenty minutes (2 hours) within a calendar month without the appropriate approval:

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|-------------------------------|--|
| 1st offence | Oral warning by the Director, Employee Relations |
| 2nd offence | Written reprimand by the Director, Employee Relations copied to Supervisor |
| 3rd offence | Stronger letter of reprimand by the Director, Employee Relations copied to the Supervisor/Human Resource Human Executive Committee |
| 4th offence | Disciplinary action <u>not</u> with a view to dismissal |
| 5th offence | Disciplinary action <u>with</u> a view to dismissal |

Type of Offence	1 st Offence	2 nd Offence	3 rd Offence	4 th Offence	5 th Offence
Being late for work more than 5 times or having a total loss of more than 120 mins or 2 hrs within a calendar month without the appropriate approval	Oral warning by the Director, Employee Relations	Written reprimand by the Director, Employee Relations copied to Supervisor	Stronger letter of reprimand by the Director, Employee Relations copied to the Supervisor/Human Resource Executive Committee	Disciplinary action <u>not</u> with a view to dismissal	Disciplinary action <u>with</u> a view to dismissal

5.2 The foregoing sanctions relate to any four (4) months and not only consecutive months in each calendar year.

2b.

- a. Ceasing work before normal time
- b. Overstaying the time allotted for lunch
- c. Absenteeism (unauthorized absence on any work day)
- d. Leaving the place of work during working hours without permission

1st offence	Counselling by the supervisor
2nd offence	Written reprimand by the supervisor and copied to the Director, Employee Relations
3rd offence	Stronger letter of reprimand by the Director, Employee Relations
4th offence	Disciplinary action <u>not</u> with a view to dismissal

Type of Offence	1 st Offence	2 nd Offence	3 rd Offence	4 th Offence	5 th Offence
Ceasing work before normal time	Counselling by the Supervisor	Written reprimand by the Supervisor and copied to the Director, Employee Relations	Stronger letter of reprimand by the Director, Employee Relations	Disciplinary action <u>not</u> with a view to dismissal	
Overstaying the time allotted for lunch					
Absenteeism (unauthorized absence on any work day)					
Leaving the place of work during working hours without permission					

5.3 Loss of man-hours through romping in the office, entertaining friends in the office, recreational reading, playing of games etc.

- 1st offence Counselling by the supervisor
 2nd offence Written warning by the Director, Employee Relations
 3rd offence Disciplinary action **not** with a view to dismissal

Type of Offence	1 st Offence	2 nd Offence	3 rd Offence	4 th Offence	5 th Offence
Loss of man hours through romping in the office etc.	Counselling by the Supervisor	Written Warning by the Director, Employee Relations	Disciplinary action <u>not</u> with a view to dismissal		

5.4 Sleeping on the job

- 1st offence Counselling to determine reason
 2nd offence Oral reprimand
 3rd offence Medical attention to determine reason
 4th offence Written reprimand by the Director, Employee Relations
 5th offence Disciplinary action **not** with a view to dismissal

Type of Offence	1 st Offence	2 nd Offence	3 rd Offence	4 th Offence	5 th Offence
Sleeping on the Job	Counselling to determine reason	Oral reprimand	Medical attention to require reason	Written reprimand by the Director, Employee Relations	Disciplinary action <u>not</u> with a view to dismissal

5.5 Attendance Register

- a. Signing the Attendance Register or Time- Off Register for another officer/employee.
- b. Tampering with the Attendance Register or Time- Off Register, and falsification of entries therein or causing falsification of entries therein.

1st offence Oral reprimand
2nd offence Written reprimand by the Director, Employee Relations
3rd offence Disciplinary action **not** with a view to dismissal

Type of Offence	1 st Offence	2 nd Offence	3 rd Offence	4 th Offence	5 th Offence
Signing the attendance register or time-off register for another employee	Oral reprimand	Written reprimand by the Director, Employee Relations	Disciplinary action <u>not</u> with a view to dismissal		
Tampering with the attendance register or time-off register, and falsification of entries therein etc.	Oral reprimand	Written reprimand by the Director, Employee Relations	Disciplinary action <u>not</u> with a view to dismissal		

All supervisors should ensure that this policy is applied consistently throughout all areas/units and all employees are made aware of the guidelines.